

Open-ended responses were coded separately by question using question-specific, multi-label codebooks. A response could receive more than one code, so percentages within a question do not necessarily sum to 100%. Two researchers independently coded a subset of responses and achieved substantial agreement (Cohen's $\kappa = 0.86$). Disagreements were resolved through discussion before coding the remaining responses.

Table 1: Final strength judgment reasoning ($N = 1, 201$).

Parent category	Lower-level code	Definition	<i>n</i>	%
Participant's own assessment of the password		Reasoning based on password properties or the participant's own knowledge, experience, or criteria rather than PSM feedback.	773	64.4
	Password construction / complexity	References password length, character types, symbols, case, or overall structural complexity.	537	44.7
	Predictability / commonness / guessability	References common words or names, obvious patterns, randomness, predictability, or ease of guessing or cracking.	399	33.2
PSM feedback as evidence	Prior knowledge / experience / personal criteria	Explicitly relies on the participant's own knowledge, experience, intuition, or personal standard for password strength.	187	15.6
		Reasoning that treats one or more PSM ratings, or agreement or disagreement across PSMs, as evidence about password strength.	421	35.1
	Direct PSM evidence	Uses one or more PSM or website ratings directly as evidence for the final strength judgment.	330	27.5
	Agreement / majority across PSMs	Uses consensus, unanimity, majority, or the number of PSMs giving each rating as evidence.	201	16.7
	Conflicting PSM evidence	Treats disagreement or mixed ratings across PSMs as relevant to the final judgment or uncertainty.	37	3.1
Others		Restates the outcome, is too vague or off-topic, or provides no identifiable substantive rationale.	174	14.5

Table 2: Final action reasoning ($N = 1, 201$).

Parent category	Lower-level code	Definition	<i>n</i>	%
Assessment of what should be done with the password		Reasoning about whether the password is adequate, should be strengthened or replaced, or raises security or usability concerns.	1,007	83.8
	Password adequacy / inadequacy	Judges the action based on whether the password itself is sufficiently strong, too weak, too simple, predictable, or guessable.	720	60.0
	Repairability / strengthening	Treats the password as usable after modification, such as adding or changing characters.	307	25.6
	Replace / start over	Concludes that the password should be discarded and replaced rather than modified.	122	10.2
	Security / precaution	Invokes security risk, compromise, account protection, or precaution as a reason for the action.	217	18.1
	Usability / effort	Invokes memorability, convenience, effort, or practicality as a reason for the action.	146	12.2
		Reasoning in which PSM feedback directly informs what the participant would do with the password.	251	20.9
PSM feedback as an action cue	Direct PSM action cue	Uses the PSM or website rating itself as a direct reason to use, modify, replace, or seek more information.	235	19.6
	Agreement / disagreement as action cue	Uses agreement, majority, or conflict across PSMs as a direct cue for the intended action.	73	6.1
Others		Restates the action, is too vague or off-topic, or provides no identifiable substantive rationale.	140	11.7

Table 3: Judgment trajectory reasoning ($N = 1, 189$).

Parent category	Lower-level code	Definition	<i>n</i>	%
Sequential processing of PSM ratings		Reasoning that explicitly describes how judgments changed as successive PSM ratings were encountered.	697	58.6
	Direct feedback-driven updating	States that the judgment changed because of a current or particular PSM rating.	355	29.9
	Accumulation / repeated evidence	Describes evidence accumulating or becoming more persuasive as additional ratings were seen.	311	26.2
	Switch-related reconsideration	Describes a change in rating direction or conflicting feedback as prompting re-evaluation.	58	4.9
	Explicit sequence / progression	Explicitly refers to first, then, later, or Websites A-D when explaining the judgment trajectory.	283	23.8
Related new feedback to an existing judgment		Reasoning about how incoming feedback confirmed, challenged, or failed to change a judgment already in place.	464	39.0
	Confirmation / reinforcement	Describes feedback as confirming, validating, or reinforcing an existing judgment.	113	9.5
	Reconsideration / second-guessing	Describes feedback as causing the participant to question, rethink, or revise an earlier judgment.	91	7.7
	Judgment remained relatively stable	States that the participant maintained the earlier judgment or that the feedback did little to change it.	316	26.6
Participant's own assessment		Reasoning in which the trajectory remains anchored in the participant's own knowledge, initial judgment, or assessment of password features.	542	45.6
	Independent password / self anchor	Explicitly anchors judgment in own knowledge, the initial assessment, or password features across the task.	542	45.6
Others		Restates the trajectory, is too vague or off-topic, or provides no identifiable substantive rationale.	166	14.0

Table 4: Self vs. PSM decision process ($N = 835$).

Parent category	Lower-level code	Definition	<i>n</i>	%
Reasons for relying on oneself		Reasons for giving greater weight to the participant's own assessment when it differed from a PSM rating.	592	70.9
	Knowledge / experience / intuition	Relies on personal expertise, education, experience, or intuition as the basis for greater confidence in one's own judgment.	414	49.6
	Password-specific features	Uses concrete password properties or familiar password requirements to evaluate whether the PSM rating is reasonable.	296	35.4
Reasons for relying on PSM feedback		Reasons for giving greater weight to PSM feedback than to the participant's own assessment.	158	18.9
	Direct PSM deference	Directly states that the participant followed or relied on the PSM rating.	30	3.6
	PSM expertise / technical authority	Treats the PSM as more expert, objective, technically capable, or reliable than the participant.	57	6.8
	Cross-PSM corroboration	Treats agreement or majority across multiple PSMs as corroborating external evidence.	106	12.7
		Reasoning that explicitly balances self-assessment and PSM feedback or applies a rule for deciding which to trust.	108	12.9
Conditional evaluation of self vs. PSM	Explicit balancing / relative weighting	Describes comparing both sources or changing their relative weight based on confidence or the situation.	40	4.8
	Plausibility / fit	Accepts or rejects PSM feedback according to whether it makes sense or fits the participant's own assessment.	24	2.9
	PSM skepticism / opacity / differing standards	Reduces reliance on PSM feedback because of opacity, differing standards, implausible output, or reliability concerns.	47	5.6
Others		Restates the reliance choice, is too vague or off-topic, or provides no identifiable substantive rationale.	129	15.4

Table 5: Resolving conflict across PSMs ($N = 698$).

Parent category	Lower-level code	Definition	<i>n</i>	%
PSM-based resolution strategies		Strategies that use the distribution, ordering, or selected subset of PSM ratings to resolve disagreement across websites.	228	32.7
	Majority / count rule	Follows the rating direction given by more websites, such as a 3-of-4 majority.	96	13.8
	Outlier dismissal	Down-weights or ignores a lone or minority PSM rating.	10	1.4
	Averaging / integration	Combines or averages multiple PSM ratings rather than following a single rating.	29	4.2
	Sequence / recency	Assigns weight based on when a rating appeared, such as first, later, or most recent feedback.	32	4.6
Own judgment, knowledge, or password features	Direct / selective PSM reliance	Relies on one or more PSM ratings without specifying a more precise aggregation rule.	100	14.3
		Uses independent assessment as a tiebreaker when PSM ratings conflict.	450	64.5
	Own judgment / intuition	Returns to the participant's own assessment or intuition when the PSMs disagree.	222	31.8
	Knowledge / experience	Uses prior knowledge, education, reading, or experience to resolve the conflict.	122	17.5
	Password-feature tiebreaker	Uses password length, patterns, character composition, predictability, or similar features to decide which feedback is more plausible.	197	28.2
Source credibility / standards	Safety-first reasoning under conflict	Chooses the more conservative interpretation to avoid false reassurance or security risk.	24	3.4
		Evaluates the reliability, criteria, standards, or expertise of the PSM sources when deciding which rating to trust.	46	6.6
Others	Source credibility / standards	Explicitly compares or questions PSM reliability, criteria, standards, or expertise.	46	6.6
		Restates the conflict, is too vague or off-topic, or provides no identifiable substantive rationale.	102	14.6

Table 6: Repeated same-direction rating reasoning ($N = 499$).

Parent category	Lower-level code	Definition	<i>n</i>	%
Repeated ratings added support		Treats repeated same-direction ratings as additional corroborating or cumulative evidence.	265	53.1
	Agreement treated as corroborating evidence	Treats consistent ratings across multiple sources as corroboration that the rating is accurate.	198	39.7
Repetition changed relation to prior view	Cumulative persuasion	Describes repeated exposure as gradually increasing the persuasive force of the feedback.	90	18.0
		Describes repetition as confirming, strengthening confidence in, or prompting reconsideration of a prior judgment.	156	31.3
	Confirmation	Treats repeated ratings as validating or reinforcing the participant's initial judgment.	63	12.6
	Increased certainty / confidence	States that repeated agreement made the participant more certain or confident.	66	13.2
	Reconsideration / second-guessing	States that repetition caused the participant to doubt or adjust the initial view.	39	7.8
Repetition added little / created resistance		Describes repeated ratings as having little additional influence or becoming redundant.	70	14.0
	No additional effect	Explicitly states that additional repeated ratings did not further change the judgment.	67	13.4
	Diminishing value of repeated ratings	Describes later identical ratings as redundant or as providing less marginal value than earlier ratings.	3	0.6
Repetition triggered skepticism		Describes repeated agreement itself as a reason to question PSM quality or validity.	17	3.4
	Skepticism triggered by repetition	Explicitly states that uniform or repeated ratings increased skepticism about the PSMs.	17	3.4
Others		Restates the effect of repetition, is too vague or off-topic, or provides no identifiable substantive rationale.	90	18.0

Table 7: Trust reasoning ($N = 1,201$).

Parent category	Lower-level code	Definition	<i>n</i>	%
Cross-PSM evidence pattern		Trust reasoning based on whether PSM ratings agreed or conflicted across websites.	532	44.3
	Agreement / corroboration	Uses consensus, majority, or repeated agreement across PSMs as a signal of trustworthiness.	404	33.6
Calibration against own assessment	Conflict / inconsistency	Uses disagreement or inconsistent ratings across PSMs as a reason to reduce or reconsider trust.	157	13.1
		Calibrates trust in PSMs by comparing their ratings with the participant's own judgment or knowledge of the password.	540	45.0
	Agreement / plausibility	Increases trust when the PSM output agrees with the participant's own assessment or appears plausible.	83	6.9
	Mismatch / implausibility	Reduces trust when PSM output conflicts with the participant's assessment or obvious password properties.	25	2.1
	Own/password-based calibration	Uses personal knowledge, experience, or concrete password features to assess PSM credibility.	484	40.3
PSM / source qualities		Trust reasoning based on the perceived methods, transparency, authority, capability, or prior reputation of PSMs.	341	28.4
	Standards / methods / criteria	Evaluates the standards, criteria, algorithms, or methods used by PSMs.	127	10.6
	Transparency / explanation	Bases trust on whether the PSM explains its rating or provides enough detail about its criteria.	41	3.4
	Authority / capability / credibility	Bases trust on perceived expertise, technical capability, reliability, purpose, or integrity of the PSM.	158	13.2
	Prior experience / baseline trust	Explains current trust using prior experience with PSMs or an existing tendency to trust or distrust them.	71	5.9
Others		Restates the trust direction, is too vague or off-topic, or provides no identifiable substantive rationale.	233	19.4

Percentages use the number of responses to the corresponding question as the denominator.